



DELHI PUBLIC SCHOOL NEWTOWN
SESSION 2024-25
MONDAY TEST

CLASS: VIII
SUBJECT: ENGLISH PAPER I

FULL MARKS: 40
DATE: 18.10.24

General Instructions:

- The question paper consists of five printed pages.
- Answers should be to the point.
- Copy the question numbers carefully before answering the questions.
- Marks will be deducted for spelling errors.

SECTION A

I. Choose the most appropriate option-

[1x10=10]

a. This hotel is better than most others we have stayed in. (*Change into Positive degree*)

- i. This hotel is as good as any other hotel we have stayed in.**
- ii. This hotel is better than any other hotel we have stayed in.**
- iii. Very few hotels we have stayed in are as good as this one.**
- iv. No other hotel we have stayed in is better than this hotel.**

b. You cannot persuade him ____ changing his decision. (*Use a suitable preposition*)

- i. beside ii. from iii. off iv. out**

c. Chennai is the most populous city in the south of India. (*Choose the correct sentence having the usage 'any other'*)

- i. Any other city in the south of India has fewer people than Chennai.**
- ii. Chennai is as populous as any other city in the south of India.**
- iii. Chennai is more populous than any other city in the south of India.**
- iv. Any other city in the south of India is less populous than Chennai.**

d. The guests were surprised when the event coordinator bumped at the catering staff. (*Rewrite the sentence by choosing the correct preposition*)

- i. into ii. within iii. on iv. for**

e. Playing chess is more stimulating than watching television. (*Change the degree*)

i. Watching TV is less stimulating than playing chess.

ii. Watching television is not as stimulating as playing chess.

iii. Between watching television and playing chess, watching television is more stimulating.

iv. It is not as stimulating to watch television as to play chess.

f. The lack of proper infrastructure is a barrier ____ development. (*Use a suitable preposition*)

i. to

ii. towards

iii. on

iv. At

g. Few places are as beautiful as the Grand Canyon. (*Choose the correct sentence ending with: ...places.*)

i. The Grand Canyon is more beautiful than any other places.

ii. The Grand Canyon is as beautiful as all other places.

iii. The Grand Canyon is as beautiful as most other places.

iv. The Grand Canyon is more beautiful than most other places.

h. This book has been particularly useful within my research. (*Rewrite the sentence by choosing the correct preposition*)

i. at

ii. for

iii. without

iv. on

i. This book is more interesting than that one. (*Choose the sentence having the correct usage- 'as...as'*)

i. This book is as interesting as that one.

ii. No other book is as interesting as that one.

iii. That book is not as interesting as this one.

iv. This book is not as interesting as that one.

j. She was invited to the meeting but was not able to attend because she was out ____ the office. (*Use a suitable preposition*)

i. of

ii. in

iii. at

iv. on

SECTION B

II. Fill in the blanks with appropriate words-

[½x10=5]

The summer festival, also called Midsomer, is celebrated____(1) the town square every year. It is a highlight____(2) the year for many residents. People eagerly look forward____(3) the various activities and performances. Tourists _____(4) all around the world throng here to bask _____(5) the atmosphere of celebration. As I explored the festival, I was sure to keep my attention____(6) the different booths and attractions_____(7) me. Due to the parade, I could have easily become distracted, but I told myself that I should stay focused_____(8) the events I wanted to attend, or I might miss out on memorable experiences _____(9) the season. In addition, I took photos _____(10) the lively scenes to remember the vibrant festival long after it ended.

III. Do as directed-

[1x5=5]

- i. This book is more fascinating than any other book I have read. (*Change into Superlative degree*)
- ii. That was the most challenging puzzle I have ever encountered. (*Begin with: No other puzzle....*)
- iii. No other musician plays the piano as beautifully as she does. (*End with: ...musician.*)
- iv. Ramesh is the most athletic of all the boys. (*End with:Ramesh.*)
- v. My brother can run faster than most other runners. (*Change into Positive degree*)

IV. Read the passage and answer the questions that follow-

Detective Rosa Montrose, belonging to the quaint little town of Norsbury was used to solving high-profile cases—robberies, fraud, even the occasional kidnapping. However, when Mrs. Evelyn Carter, a frail elderly woman, hobbled into her office one rainy afternoon, Rosa found herself face-to-face with an unusual case. Evelyn’s beloved Persian cat, Buttons, had gone missing.

“I know it might seem trivial,” Evelyn said, clutching a red umbrella in her hand. “But my cat means the world to me. She’s all I have. I had to come here!”

Rosa saw the desperation in the woman’s eyes, and decided to help her. “When did Buttons disappear?” she asked.

“Two days ago. I let her out into the garden, like I do every evening so she can have her daily neighbourhood walk, but she never came back,” Evelyn explained, her fingers tightening around the umbrella. “The weather’s been terrible ever since. I’m worried she might be lost.”

Though this wasn’t her usual line of work, Rosa agreed to take the case. After all, solving puzzles was her forte, and this was just another mystery. After taking down the notes she needed to solve this mystery, Rosa grabbed her trench coat and stepped out into the rain, noting the atrocious weather.

“The investigation is going to be hard in this weather, with the mud and the rain,” Rosa said to herself. “How will I even perceive the cat’s whereabouts? There will be no pawprints left!”

Her first stop was Evelyn’s house, a cozy cottage nestled on the outskirts of town. The garden was a lush, tangled mess of overgrown flowers, vines, and birdbaths, but something stood out. Just beyond the gate, near a muddy trail, lay a patch of fur—white fur, like Buttons.

Rosa bent down and examined the trail. Paw prints led away from the house, towards the neighbouring woods. She followed the prints, her boots sinking into the wet earth as the rain continued to pour.

Halfway into the woods, Rosa spotted something strange: a red umbrella propped against a tree. She recognized it immediately. It was identical to the one Evelyn had been holding earlier that day. But how did it get here?

As Rosa moved closer, a faint sound caught her attention—a soft meow. She followed the sound and found Buttons perched on a tree branch, tangled in the branches, unable to come down.

After rescuing the cat, Rosa inspected the red umbrella. It had been left there deliberately, leading her to Buttons. She realised Mrs. Evelyn had known where the cat was all along. She wasn’t losing her memory—she was testing Rosa’s abilities, curious to see if the detective would take her seriously.

Rosa snuggled Buttons, and carried her inside, handing her over to the now impressed Mrs. Evelyn.

a) For each word given below choose the correct meaning (as used in the passage) from the options provided:

[2]

i. *frail*

- a) tired
- b) unwell
- c) weak
- d) indisposed

ii. *forte*

- a) expertise
- b) advantage
- c) incompetence
- d) interest

b) Which word in the passage means the opposite of the word ‘*accidentally*’?

[1]

- i. immediately
- ii. deliberately
- iii. daily
- iv. seriously

c) Answer the following questions briefly in your own words-

- i. Why did Evelyn come to see Detective Rosa Montrose?** [2]
- ii. When and how did the cat disappear?** [2]
- iii. Quote the sentence from the passage which tells us that the red umbrella was significant in the story.** [1]
- iv. Give a description of Evelyn's garden.** [2]
- v. Why did Rosa think that the investigation will be difficult?** [2]

d) In not more than 50 words, write how Rosa found the clues and eventually rescued Buttons. [8]